BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Treatment checks across the course

Relative stages, not equally spaced dates. Agree who books each check, reviews results and gives advice if a check is missed.

Check	Before starting	First treatment	During treatment	Phase / dose review	After treatment
Bloods and symptoms	Blood count, kidney/liver, glucose, thyroid and viral checks; renal estimate	Folate and B12 in place before pemetrexed	Blood count, kidney/liver and glucose each cycle; thyroid every 3–6 weeks	After up to four cycles: carboplatin ends; continue maintenance checks	Folic acid for 21 days after last pemetrexed; remain alert to delayed immune symptoms
Treatment review	Confirm exact cancer setting and biomarkers	Explain expected benefit and how it will be assessed	Report new symptoms between visits	Review response, tolerability and active medicines	Agree the next treatment or surveillance plan
Vitamins and steroids	Folic acid lead-in and B12 in preceding week	One reconciled steroid prescription	Daily folate; B12 every three cycles while pemetrexed continues	Keep vitamins and rash prophylaxis in maintenance; review antiemetics	Folate continues for 21 days after final pemetrexed
Platinum effects	Baseline nerve/hearing and renal assessment	Check kidney function and carboplatin prescription	Nerve/hearing review before each platinum cycle	No carboplatin in maintenance; follow any persisting effects	Follow unresolved kidney, hearing or nerve effects

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00568 v5 · official regimen

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Pembrolizumab + pemetrexed + carboplatin: treatment and checks

First-line metastatic non-squamous non-small-cell lung cancer (NSCLC) without EGFR or ALK alterations

Induction: all three medicines on Day 1 every 21 days for up to four cycles. Maintenance: carboplatin stops; pembrolizumab and pemetrexed may continue every 21 days while appropriate.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	First treatment	During treatment	Phase / dose review	After treatment
Treatment NCCP 00568	Confirm exact indication and planned course	Start the source-specific schedule	Continue the active phase as prescribed	Confirm hold, restart, maintenance or completion	Agree follow-up and next decision

Care / check	Before starting	First treatment	During treatment	Phase / dose review	After treatment
Bloods and symptoms NCCP 00568	Blood count, kidney/liver, glucose, thyroid and viral checks; renal estimate	Folate and B12 in place before pemetrexed	Blood count, kidney/liver and glucose each cycle; thyroid every 3–6 weeks	After up to four cycles: carboplatin ends; continue maintenance checks	Folic acid for 21 days after last pemetrexed; remain alert to delayed immune symptoms
Treatment review NCCP 00568	Confirm exact cancer setting and biomarkers	Explain expected benefit and how it will be assessed	Report new symptoms between visits	Review response, tolerability and active medicines	Agree the next treatment or surveillance plan
Vitamins and steroids NCCP 00568	Folic acid lead-in and B12 in preceding week	One reconciled steroid prescription	Daily folate; B12 every three cycles while pemetrexed continues	Keep vitamins and rash prophylaxis in maintenance; review antiemetics	Folate continues for 21 days after final pemetrexed
Platinum effects NCCP 00568	Baseline nerve/hearing and renal assessment	Check kidney function and carboplatin prescription	Nerve/hearing review before each platinum cycle	No carboplatin in maintenance; follow any persisting effects	Follow unresolved kidney, hearing or nerve effects

What each check is for

1 Before starting

Before first dose

Confirm suitability and baseline safety

Ask / **act:** Confirm results, prescriptions and responsible teams.

Sources: NCCP 00568

2 Whole-course and completion review

At phase change or completion

Some checks and support continue after a drug stops

Ask / **act:** Provide the ongoing monitoring and urgent-contact plan.

Sources: NCCP 00568

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-10-29 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.27